

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Threat Detection and Intelligence | Microsoft Sentinel | CrowdStrike | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of specialist experience in threat detection, threat intelligence, and incident response, dedicated to strengthening and maturing cyber defence capabilities in large enterprise environments. I have deep expertise in Microsoft Sentinel, leveraging Kusto Query Language (KQL) to build, tune, and optimise detection rules and automated playbooks that deliver high-fidelity alerts and faster Mean Time to Detect (MTTD). I am highly proficient with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, having led the deployment across 8,000 users, and I have extensive experience with CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM) and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) for proactive threat hunting. I have a strong track record in leading incident response activities following the NIST Special Publication 800-61 Computer Security Incident Handling Guide and MITRE ATT&CK framework, coordinating with internal IT teams and external managed Security Operations Centre (SOC) providers to investigate, contain, and remediate threats. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and consistently deliver robust, compliant, and future-ready security controls across cloud and infrastructure environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL); CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; detection rule engineering; alert tuning and false positive reduction; proactive threat hunting
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) / Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft 365 Defender; CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 Computer Security Incident Handling Guide; MITRE ATT&CK framework; coordination with internal IT and external managed SOC providers
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure; Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory); Conditional Access; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** SOAR playbook development; PowerShell scripting; automated alert triage and response workflows
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); AppCheck; Nessus
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust
- **Email Security:** Mimecast
- **Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM):** Microsoft Intune (8,000-user deployment)
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF); Centre for Internet Security (CIS) Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials Plus; MITRE ATT&CK
- **Reporting and Compliance:** Security posture monitoring and reporting; control effectiveness measurement; compliance with ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, and NIST CSF

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead threat detection, hunting, and incident response operations using Microsoft Sentinel, building and optimising detection rules with Kusto Query Language (KQL) to identify Advanced Persistent Threat (APT) activity, lateral movement, and insider threats across cloud and on-premises environments
- Manage and enhance Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, continuously improving detection coverage and ensuring

rapid, accurate alert triage and response

- Coordinate with external managed Security Operations Centre (SOC) providers to investigate and respond to security alerts, ensuring consistent and effective threat response aligned with established playbooks and escalation procedures
- Detect, analyse, and respond to evolving threats using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR, leveraging Falcon Insight and Falcon Discover for comprehensive endpoint visibility and proactive threat hunting
- Manage identity security through Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, and MFA, implementing Zero Trust controls to protect against identity-based attacks and credential compromise
- Continuously monitor, enhance, and report on security controls across cloud and infrastructure environments, ensuring controls are robust, compliant, and aligned with NIST CSF, ISO 27001, and Cyber Essentials Plus
- Lead incident response activities following the NIST SP 800-61 Computer Security Incident Handling Guide and MITRE ATT&CK framework, coordinating containment, digital forensics, and remediation across IT and business teams
- Automate threat detection and response using Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) capabilities and PowerShell scripting, reducing analyst workload and improving Mean Time to Respond (MTTR)
- Conduct vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and AppCheck, remediating findings to reduce attack surface across cloud and on-premises infrastructure
- Implement and manage Privileged Access Management (PAM) using BeyondTrust, enforcing least-privilege access and protecting critical systems from privilege escalation attacks
- Deliver regular security posture reporting to senior leadership, communicating threat landscape insights, control effectiveness, and remediation progress

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Supported threat detection and incident response operations, triaging alerts from Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon, and Microsoft Defender platforms, escalating and coordinating responses in line with established playbooks
- Contributed to the deployment and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, expanding coverage and improving detection fidelity
- Assisted in building and tuning Microsoft Sentinel detection rules using KQL, reducing false positive rates and improving alert quality for the security operations function
- Coordinated with external managed SOC providers to ensure consistent alert investigation and response, maintaining clear communication and documentation throughout the incident lifecycle
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, and MFA configurations, supporting identity security governance and access lifecycle management
- Participated in vulnerability management activities using Tenable.io and Nessus, identifying, tracking, and remediating security findings across IT infrastructure
- Supported the development of SOAR automation playbooks to improve alert enrichment, triage, and response efficiency
- Contributed to security posture reporting, preparing metrics and dashboards for senior stakeholders on detection, incident, and vulnerability management performance

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Delivered IT security, infrastructure quality, and operational engineering support within a fast-paced Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) environment
- Administered endpoint security controls, firewall configurations, and identity and access management processes, maintaining a robust security posture across corporate infrastructure
- Contributed to vulnerability assessments and security policy development, supporting compliance with industry security standards
- Provided technical support for IT infrastructure, collaborating with development and operations teams to resolve security and operational issues efficiently

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender across 8,000 users, establishing end-to-end threat visibility and significantly improving detection coverage across endpoints, identity, and cloud workloads
- Built and continuously optimised a comprehensive Microsoft Sentinel detection rule library using Kusto Query Language (KQL), materially improving threat detection fidelity and reducing false positive rates for the security operations function
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR across a large enterprise environment, enabling proactive threat hunting and rapid automated alert response at scale
- Implemented Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using PowerShell, automating routine alert triage and investigation workflows and significantly reducing analyst workload
- Led incident response operations for complex security incidents following NIST SP 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK, successfully containing and remediating threats with minimal business impact
- Managed a comprehensive vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, and Nessus, achieving measurable reduction in the organisation's critical and high-severity vulnerability exposure
- Contributed to achieving and maintaining Cyber Essentials Plus certification, validating robust security controls across the organisation

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (Bristol/UK)